

Spot node pools

- Distinct category of VMs that let you leverage Azure's underutilized capacity at a significant cost reduction of up to 90%
- Utilizing Spot VMs for your AKS cluster's nodes enables you to significantly reduce the cost of Azure's unused capacity. Based on a number of factors, like node size, region, and time of day, the amount of potential unutilized capacity will change. Spot nodes act as standard instances, but at any time Azure needs that capacity, they will evict the spot nodes
- If there is capacity available when you deploy a spot node pool, Azure will allocate the spot nodes
- For the Spot nodes, there isn't any SLA or high-availability
- Spot nodes serve well for workloads that can tolerate evictions, early terminations, and interruptions like batch processing jobs, development environments, and testing environments

Spot node pools

- The cluster's default node pool cannot be a Spot node pool
- A Spot node pool must use Virtual Machine Scale Sets
- Spot nodes have the label `kubernetes.azure.com/scalesetpriority:spot`, the taint `kubernetes.azure.com/scalesetpriority=spot:NoSchedule`
 - System pods have anti-affinity to avoid getting scheduled on spot nodes
 - For pods that you would like to dedicatedly run on spot nodes, you will need to set a toleration and a node affinity
- The following parameters are relevant when creating a spot node pool:
 - `--priority`
 - Spot
 - `--eviction-policy`
 - Delete
 - Deallocate
 - `--spot-max-price`
 - -1
 - any value greater than 0, up to 5 decimal places (for example 0.98765)